

RESIDENCE LIFE MANUAL

Residence Life is committed to providing a safe, clean, and well-maintained residential community. Residential living provides many opportunities for students to:

- experience living independently.
- to interact with a peer group that is experiencing the same unique demands made of a university student.
- to develop the requisite skills to become a community leader.
- to experience a diversity of lifestyles and values
- to participate in social and developmental activities

To be effective, residents must treat each other with mutual respect, support, trust, and interdependence, while recognizing the strengths and limitations of others. Being a Shaw University student means exhibiting respect to your roommate and all residents of your floor, your building, and your campus community.

Residence Hall Policies

Non-Refundable Housing Fee

Each student must pay a non-refundable housing reservation/application fee to reserve a room. The fee for prospective students is included in the enrollment deposit. For all other students requesting campus housing the fee must be paid before the application can be submitted. First and second year students receive priority housing. Returning students are housed based upon space availability and compliance with university financial requirements. Payment of a room application fee does not entitle a resident to a particular room, but instead a space in a room. All students may be assigned a roommate.

Residential Requirement

Shaw University's Residence Life and Housing policy requires that residents be fulltime students to reside in campus housing. All full-time first-year students and sophomores **must** eat and reside on campus. Students with certain circumstances may request a waiver to the policy before they report to campus. The Office of Residence Life must approve exceptions to this policy which include:

- Live with a parent or legal guardian within a 50-mile radius
- Be 21 years of age or live independently at the time of admission.
- Be veterans (180 or more consecutive days of military service)
- Be Married or responsible for dependent individual(s)

Residence Hall Conduct Guidelines

All University students are subject to the conduct guidelines as outlined in this guidebook.

A. Depriving Others of Their Rights

Students are free to express themselves in a responsible manner. Such expression is unacceptable when the expression impinges on the rights of others, or when it disrupts administrative activities or approved programs or events. A roommate who subjects others in the room to systemic stress and harassment will be subject to disciplinary actions.

B. Damaging Another Person's or University Property

Instances where damage to property occurs, the student causing the damage will be expected to compensate the owner for the loss of the property and will be subject to disciplinary actions. When University property is damaged, the student will be required to make restitution. Students of residence hall rooms will be held responsible for damage to

the room and/ or furnishings.

C. Verbal Abuse

Verbal Abuse, threat of force or intimidation of others is unacceptable and is subject to disciplinary action.

D. Chronic Misbehavior

A pattern of unacceptable misconduct or residence violations even if the infractions are minor may be interpreted as a disciplinary problem. Residents must comply with the directives of university personnel, including Hall Staff, Campus Police and Security, and others appointed by the Office of Residence Life and Housing. Students who fail to comply with disciplinary sanctions imposed by proper authority may result in disciplinary measures, which could include but not limited to the termination of the Housing Contract.

Smoking Policy

Shaw University is a smoke-free campus. Smoking in any form is prohibited anywhere on campus. This includes the use of marijuana, cigarettes, e-cigs, cigars, blunts, vape pens bongs and pipes. All students and visitors must adhere to the University smoking policy. Students found in violation of these policies may receive a university sanction and be subject to dismissal from university housing.

Drugs, Alcohol, and Paraphernalia

Shaw University is fully committed to achieving a drug and alcohol-free environment for its students. As such, the University has a zero tolerance for illegal drugs, drug paraphernalia, and drinking and is prohibited for use by students in campus residence halls and campus events and any property/event owned or sponsored by Shaw University. Smoking marijuana or the smell of marijuana in a student's room may result in loss of housing and/or suspension. Violations may result in loss of housing, suspension, or arrest by local authorities.

Residential Buildings

Shaw University offers conventional, co-educational traditional residence halls for full time students. Residents live in double or triple rooms across four residence halls. Students share common bath facilities and lounge areas on single gender floors or wings.

- Talbert O. Shaw Living Learning Center Northeast Campus
- Talbert O. Shaw Living Learning Center Northeast Campus

Housing Contracts

Before moving in, each student must sign a housing contract, which specifies many of the regulations applicable to resident students. Students are advised to read the housing contract carefully before signing it. Once a student signs the housing contract, s/he is bound by its terms and must pay for the remainder of the academic year.

Residence Life Staff

The Dean of Students is responsible for the comprehensive administration of student housing, which encompasses (a) the process of admission of students to campus housing; (b) the application and assignment process; (c) residential hall staff training and supervision; and (d) departmental decision-making. The residence halls are staffed by **Residence Managers, Coordinators and Resident Advisors** who oversee the day-to-day operations and assist the residents with personal, social, and academic development and helps interpret University and Residence Hall regulations and procedures.

Resident Responsibilities

Shaw University recognizes the educational and social benefit derived from group living situations. It is important for you to understand your rights as a student and your responsibility to others. It is your responsibility to follow the guidelines created to ensure that you have a

living environment that complements the educational mission of the University, assisting you to pursue an education. As a member of the residential community, you are expected to:

- Understand and comply with all rules, regulations and policies governing residence halls.
- Act in a manner that demonstrates respect and consideration for fellow students and staff.
- Be aware of all rules, regulations, policies, and procedures stated in this handbook, housing contract and Student Handbook.

Room Charges

Standard room charges are included in the total tuition and fees and can be found on the University Fee Sheet.

Housing Assignments

New and transfer students must submit a housing application as part of the admissions process. The Housing Application is located in the BearsNet Portal and requires a username and password to access. Returning students must submit a housing application by June 15th for the upcoming year. If a student changes their status before the first day of classes, they will be charged an administrative fee and/or daily charges, whichever is greater. Otherwise, there is no refund for housing charges.

Room/Building Assignments

A student is eligible to be assigned to campus housing by completing a housing application and paying the required fee during open application periods. Student rooms are designed for two or three student occupancy. Shaw University does not sell single rooms. Unless a student purchases a premium room, a roommate will be assigned. Assignment to a specific building is based upon student classification or participation in Honors College. Spring Semester assignments are made based upon availability of beds. The University reserves the right to assign and reassign residence hall rooms and may, at its sole discretion, terminate any residence hall room assignment.

Roommate Requests

Roommate assignments are random. Students can make a roommate request at the time of application. Every effort will be made to accommodate requests when students request each other on the housing application. Students who make late requests may do so in writing before Fall Semester begins, but approval is not guaranteed. Spring Semester assignments are made based upon space availability.

Room Changes

To make administrative adjustments where necessary, there will be a 20-day room freeze at the beginning and end of each semester. Requests for roommate changes will not be processed during this time. Room changes due to roommate conflicts will not be permitted until the students have tried to reach an agreement with a Resident Advisor or Residence Coordinator. Students may be administratively removed from their assigned residence hall if they demonstrate an inability to function in the group living environment.

Check-in/Checkout

Students are responsible for completing a housing contract upon check-in and returning it to the residence hall staff. Key access is then given to an assigned room during regular academic sessions, which require their presence on campus. Keys must be returned upon check-out.

Change of Housing Status

If a student decides to change their housing status from on-campus to off-campus, or off campus to on campus, they must complete the appropriate form and pay any required fees. Room and board charges will be prorated if needed according to university policy.

Unauthorized Room Changes

The University makes room assignments without regard to age, color, creed, disability, national origin, race, or sexual orientation. Students who make unauthorized room changes will be

subject to disciplinary measures, which may include immediate removal from the unauthorized room, denial of a subsequent request to change rooms, forfeiture of the privilege of living on campus, payment of fines, or other appropriate measures.

Room Consolidations

In the case where residents have not been assigned a roommate consolidation may take place. Consolidation may require relocating students to another room. The residence hall staff will determine who has an available space in a room to which another student may be moved to or from. The Residence Hall staff may assign, re-assign and adjust the occupancy of rooms at any time to ensure maximum occupancy and efficiency.

Roommate Conflicts

When conflict or disagreement arises between individuals or groups of residents, it is best to talk with one another and resolve the issues at the most immediate level. If this is not possible, or it is unsuccessful, students should approach the Resident Assistant (RA), or Resident Coordinator (RC) for help. The RAs, and RCs will assist with conflict resolution and mediation and can utilize other campus resources when necessary. The Office of Residence Life and Housing staff is committed to helping all roommates involved in a conflict explore means of solving any conflicts either as a source of suggestions or through direct mediation. Occasionally it may be necessary to resolve a conflict through a room or hall change, although this method of resolution is used as a last resort.

Improper Check-Out

Failure to check out as during non-academic periods will result in a fee of \$50.00 as well as an additional \$150.00 fee to replace the core of the door lock, should the key not be returned. Students are required to vacate the resident halls 24 hours after their last exam. A student who is dismissed or who voluntarily withdraws from the University must vacate the residence hall immediately or as instructed.

Break Housing

Students are required to vacate the residence halls during defined non-academic closings - winter, spring, and summer breaks. Room fees do not include these periods of closure. If a student is unable to go home during the break, he or she must take the responsibility for arranging off-campus temporary accommodations in advance of closing. Exceptions to this policy may be made for in-season athletes, students participating in student-teaching, internships or enrolled in CRC classes. Otherwise, all students are expected to clean their rooms for inspection and vacate the resident hall within 24 hours after their last examination at a semesters' end. Any student who stays in a residence hall after the designated closing date will be assessed a \$100.00 fine daily for checking out late.

Room Furnishings

All student rooms are furnished with beds, mattresses, desks, dressers, chairs, wardrobes, and blinds, smoke detectors, internet, and cable access. This furniture should not be removed. Double mattresses are prohibited unless a student purchases their own. Students should report damaged furniture to staff upon check-in and check-out to avoid being charged. Students may be charged for room furniture moved to hallways and common areas from their assigned room.

Room Keys and Lockout Service

Residents are issued a key for their use only upon completion of the Housing Contract and assigned a room. Keys are the property of the university and are not to be duplicated, shared, or loaned to other people. Students are required to always carry their room key. There is a **\$5.00** charge for students locked out of their rooms. Students who are locked out of their rooms must show proof of occupancy before receiving lockout service. If a room key is lost, the student will be charged \$150 for the cost of a lock change.

Room Inspections

Room inspections will be conducted on a regular basis as determined by the residence staff. Official room inspection does not require that the occupants be present. The University reserves the right to inspect any room or any other portion of its premises at any time and without notice.

Room Entry/Inspection and Property

While respecting privacy, the University and its agents unconditionally reserve the right to enter and/or inspect its property. These times may include but are not limited to:

- exterminating
- performing repairs/make improvements.
- recover university owned property, which is not authorized.
- fire-safety inspections
- health and general welfare of a resident
- the protection of university or student property

While entry without notice may be necessary, attempts will be made to provide prior notice whenever reasonable.

Damage/Community Damage

Residents may be charged for repair or replacement costs due to the removal or destruction of property in their residence hall room or public area. Community damage will be divided among the residents and assessed to each individual student account. If the individuals responsible are unknown, the occupants of the residence hall room will be expected to assume the cost of the repair or replacement. Residents are responsible for their guest(s) and, therefore, may be held responsible for any damage or violation because of the actions of a guest. The student(s) responsible for damage resulting from abuse of facilities, negligence, or means other than those attributed to normal wear and tear will be expected to assume the cost of repair or replacement. Charges may be assessed to a floor, wing, or entire building.

Quiet Hours

All students are expected to be considerate of others who are studying or sleeping twenty-four hours a day. Radios, televisions, alarm clocks, exercise equipment, conversations, should not be audible outside of a student's room.

Electronics and Appliances

The use of extension cords and unauthorized electrical appliances is prohibited. Due to voltage limitations of electrical outlets, air fryers, electric skillets, microwaves, Keurigs, hot plates, or other cooking equipment, **are not** allowed in the residence halls. Only surge protected power strips may be used to connect to electrical outlets. Computers, radios, and televisions should be turned off when a student is outside of the room. Only auto shut-off irons are permitted in the residence hall. Air conditioners (or similar cooling units) and space heaters **are not** permitted in the residence halls. Use of extension cords and/or unauthorized appliances may result in confiscation and a fine may be assessed. Repeated offenses may result in the loss of on-campus housing.

Residence Hall Services

Laundry

Debit/credit card operated washers and dryers are in each residence hall. Students should stay with their clothing for the duration of washing and drying. The University assumes no liability for lost, stolen, or damaged items.

Housekeeping

Residents are responsible for always keeping their rooms clean and sanitary. The housekeeping staff cleans bathrooms and removes trash on a daily basis. Therefore, students are required to remove all personal items from the restrooms and dispose of their trash properly. Public areas of the residence halls are cleaned on a regular basis by housekeeping staff.

Vending Machines

For residents' convenience, cash and debit/credit card vending machines are located in each residence lobby. Use of these machines is voluntary; please refer to information posted on the machine for product concerns or loss of money. The Residence halls are not responsible for losses from the use of these machines.

Extermination for Pests

While contracted services for extermination are scheduled regularly for all residence halls, Residents are expected to always maintain clean sanitary rooms. The university is not liable for the presence of bugs, vermin or insects and the presence of such will not affect the housing contract. Sightings of such should be reported immediately. Individual rooms, while occupied, will be addressed on an as needed basis.

Cable and Computer Lines

All students who reside on campus are provided with internet service which is included in tuition/fees. The University does not provide the actual instruments for service. Therefore, students should bring the following items for use in their room:

- A personal computer or laptop
- An Ethernet cable

Theft

Students are not allowed to take/use cell phones, electronic devices, clothes, credit cards or any other items that do not belong to them. Individuals who do so are expected to make restitution may be suspended from housing or from school or be subject to other disciplinary actions.

Personal Property Insurance

The University does not assume any responsibility for the loss, damage, or theft of students' personal property anywhere in the residence facility. This refers to all losses whether by fire, theft, flood or otherwise for the direct or consequential damages arising from interruption of any utility service provided by the University. Family homeowners' insurance policies may provide coverage for a student's property while at school. However, it is highly recommended that residents purchase personal property insurance. Incidents of theft should be reported to Campus Police and Security and the residence manager promptly.

Student ID

All registered students are issued an identification card and are required to always carry the card with them for building access and other campus services. ID cards must be presented to campus leadership/administration if requested. These cards remain the property of the University. Residential students must report lost or stolen identification cards to the building management. A \$25.00 fee for all lost or damaged id cards will be charged for a first-time replacement and \$50.00 for any additional replacements.

Communication

Shaw University utilizes email, text messages, and internet service systems as its primary source for communicating to the University community. REGROUP is used for emergency communications. This requires registering a cellphone number to receive messages. It is the student's responsibility to set up their SHAWBEARS.com e-mail account assigned to them by the University and to check it on a regular basis. Residents are accountable for all information communicated from the university to these systems.

Curfew

Curfew is a means of assisting students to become acclimated to university life. The University will impose curfew for the first six weeks of the semester. During curfew, students are expected to clear the "Quad" and "Courtyards, and first floor lobby areas of the residence halls. Curfew is as follows:

Sunday – Thursday	1:00 AM
Friday –Saturday	3:00 AM

Campus "Leave" Policy

Students who leave campus for more than 48 hours are required to sign the Residence Destination Logbook, which is located at the front desk at each residence hall. This policy is for the mutual protection of the student and the University.

Energy Conservation

The University continues to look for ways to conserve water, gas and electric energy use. The campus community is urged to turn off lights when not in use, and keep windows closed in buildings with central air and heat, . Students are expected to minimize use of water when

showering and avoid leaving water running in sinks in the residence halls. Any problems with heat, air or water should be reported to building management to be reported for repair.

Automobiles and Campus Parking

Freshmen are not permitted to have cars on campus without permission. All other students must purchase a decal and register their cars with Campus Police and Security. Only residents with valid “on-campus” parking decals will be permitted to park in student designated parking areas.

Visitation Policy

Visitation in the residence halls is a privilege, not a right. The University may cancel this privilege at any time, if warranted. Students may participate in general and overnight guest visitation as outlined below. Students are responsible for the behavior and activity of their guest at all times in and out of the room. Visitation may be cancelled during required University activities. Students found in violation of this policy are subject to loss of housing.

General Visitation

- Residence Life establishes visitation hours each academic year. Unless otherwise announced, visitation hours are:

Day	Hours
Monday – Thursday	5:00 p.m. – 10:00 p.m.
Friday	2:00 p.m. – 11:00 p.m.
Saturday	12:00 p.m. – 11:00p.m.
Sunday	12:00 p.m. – 10:00p.m.

Guest Registration

All guests must:

- Enter through the designated residence hall entrance.
- Present a valid government-issued photo identification.
- Register with Residence Life staff before entering the residence hall.
- Be approved by the host resident.
- Sign in electronically using the Residence Life Visitor Registration Form.
- Sign out upon departure.

Guests who fail to properly register may be denied entry.

Overnight Guests

- Overnight guests are **not permitted** in Shaw University residence halls unless expressly approved in writing by Residence Life.
- Remaining in a residence hall after visitation hours constitutes an unauthorized overnight stay and is considered a policy violation.

Right Not to Participate in Co-Ed Visitation

Any student has the right to NOT participate in co-ed visitation. However, that decision does not override the roommate’s privilege to have visitation for approved guests. It is the responsibility of roommates to manage such arrangements. If needed, residence hall staff may help with the

mediation.

Co-Ed Visitation Guidelines

Overnight stays by the opposite sex are prohibited at all times in any residence room

- Co-Ed visitation hours may vary from hall to hall. See residence hall staff for specific details.
- All visitors must enter and leave the building only through the front entrance.
- Visitors must sign in and leave their student or state issued ID card with the staff member upon entering the building.
- The host student must always accompany their guest during visitation.
- Only one visitor is allowed at a time.
- Visitors may not go above the first floor of the residence hall without clearance from the residence hall staff.
- Visitors are restricted to the room listed on the visitor's sign-in log.
- Sexual activity of any nature is always prohibited on any property owned or operated by the university.
- Students are responsible for the actions of their visitors at all times. The University Code of Conduct rules always apply. Flagrant violations of visitation guidelines could result in the cancellation of visitation privileges, cancellation of the resident's housing contract, and/or other disciplinary sanctions.

Residence Policies and Regulations

The following codes must be adhered to in the maintenance of rooms:

- Nails, tacks, and screws must not be driven into the walls, doors, windows, or furniture.
- Smoking or evidence of smoking is not permitted in any residence hall. Students will be fined and may be sanctioned up to loss of housing.
- Candles, incense, oil lamps or any other item requiring open flame (lit with a match) is strictly prohibited in the residence hall.
- Clothing and other items such as flags, blankets, pictures and the like are not to be hung on curtain rods, taped or displayed on windows or ledges in any way to attract undue attention.
- Food must be kept in containers. Unprotected food items attract rodents and insects.
- Cooking appliances are strictly prohibited. This includes grills, toasters, toaster ovens, hot plates, crock pots, electric frying pans, deep/air fryers, microwave ovens, and the like. Students found in possession of these or other appliances will be subject to a \$100.00 charge and have the item(s) confiscated.
- Extension cords are prohibited. Only surge-protected power strips are permitted. Use of extension cords may result in a \$100.00 fine and confiscation.
- Only auto-shut-off irons are permitted. Use of non-auto-shutoff irons may result in a fine and/or confiscation.
- Emotional support and service animals are only allowed once approved via the University Counseling Center and based upon space available.
- Room inspections will be conducted on a regular basis as determined by the residence staff. Official room inspection does not require that the occupants be present. The University reserves the right to inspect any room or any other portion of its premises at any time and without notice.
- Trash from a student's room must be placed in the designated trash receptacles located in common area lobbies. No trash should be dumped in bathroom trashcans. Cardboard boxes should be broken down and disposed of outside in the dumpster.
- TVs, radios, and type items must be disposed of in outside dumpsters. Items left in rooms for disposal after vacating a room will result in a \$50.00 charge which will be assessed to the responsible student and must be paid before receiving future housing.

- "Quiet Hours" in the residence halls are from twenty-four hours daily. This policy guarantees individuals freedom from noise, particularly during the late night and sleeping hours. To maintain a safe, comfortable and quiet environment, arts practice is prohibited at all times in the residence halls (i.e., practicing instruments, vocalizing, dancing, group exercising, stepping, cheerleading, using treadmills, etc.). Students who disregard this rule will be given a warning in the first instance. Persistent disregard will result in fines and possible loss of housing.

Fire Safety Policies and Drills

Mandatory fire drills will be scheduled periodically in each residence hall. Students must evacuate the building using the evacuation procedures and routes posted on each floor by all exits in the residence halls. Failure to evacuate a building or comply with instructions during a fire/fire drill evacuation, sending false fire alarms or tampering with fire safety equipment or systems is a violation of the North Carolina Fire Protection statutes and punishable by law and will result in fines and/or disciplinary action. Incense, candles, and items requiring open flame for operation, certain lamps and extension cords are PROHIBITED in the residence halls. Fire doors are to be used only in the case of emergency and drills. Any other use will result in a fine and possible loss of housing.

Prevention

Shaw University students are required to abide by regulations prescribed by the North Carolina State Fire Marshall, Shaw University Campus Police, and The Office of Facilities. Disciplinary measures will be administered against any student who violates these regulations:

- University housing foyers, stair landings, and hallways will be kept clear of unauthorized items such as furniture, curtains, bicycles, and storage containers. No item may be placed in such a way that emergency evacuation of the building is impeded.
- Hallway and stairwell doors provide a critical barrier to the spread of smoke and heat. These doors should not be propped or blocked open at any time.
- Christmas trees must not be placed indoors any longer than 14 days prior to the end of the Fall Semester. All trees must be removed from the residence halls before occupants vacate at the end of the Fall Semester. All trees shall be made of or treated with flame retardant material and maintained flame resistant regardless of height.
- No flammable liquids are permitted inside university buildings, in personal vehicles on the campus, or in university vehicles.
- Candles, incense, or open-flame devices are not permitted inside university buildings.

Setting Fires

Because of the threat of safety and damage to property, setting fires for any reason is considered felony arson. A person found to have set a fire will receive the appropriate disciplinary sanction and will be subject to prosecution in accordance with local, state, and federal laws.

False Alarms

False Alarms are a violation of fire and safety codes. Any student caught tampering with fire safety equipment will receive disciplinary sanction, be fined in accordance with the Fire Department's \$500.00 charge and be recommended for loss of housing.

Security in Residence Halls

Access doors in the residence halls are equipped with alarm systems and /or card readers for the safety and security of the occupants. Students are required to use the front door at all times. Any student who places the lives or safety of others in jeopardy by admitting unauthorized persons through an exit, or by manipulating doors so that such persons may gain entrance will be dismissed from the University.

- Visitors must enter and exit by the main entrance to the residence hall.
- Propping doors open for any reason will result in disciplinary action.
- Residents are urged to always keep room doors locked.
- Windows in air-conditioned buildings should always remain closed.

- For personal safety, windows on ground floors that may be accessible should be kept locked at all times.

Any student who observes a potentially dangerous situation or has been the victim of a crime should report this circumstance immediately to Campus Police and Security. The role and assistance of students in their own safety both inside and outside university buildings is an integral part of maintaining a safe campus.

Personal Property Security

Students should refrain from bringing items of considerable value to the residence halls. They are encouraged to purchase Personal Property and Fire Insurance. The best security system is one in which every member of the community is alert. Remember to:

- Keep residence hall doors and windows (if applicable) closed.
- Always keep your ID and room key with you.
- Use the buddy system, do not go anywhere alone at night.
- Report all suspicious persons or activities to Campus Police and Security, your Resident Advisor, Residence Coordinator, or Residence Manager.
- Never leave your possessions, including your books, unattended.
- Engrave all valuables with a personal identification number in a conspicuous place.

The University cannot assume responsibility for your personal property and will not reimburse students for losses. Consult your parent's Homeowners policy or your student property insurance policy, to file a claim.

Abandoned Property

The University does not provide storage for student property. Students are required to remove all personal property and turn in his/her keys at the time of checkout. The University assumes no responsibility for property left in residence hall rooms after a student checks out. Any property left in rooms will be considered abandoned 72 hours after the residence halls close and may be discarded. It is the responsibility of the student to contact the residence staff of forgotten items immediately and arrange pick up within that 72-hour period.

Roof Access

Access to the roofs of the residence halls and all other buildings under the University's auspices is prohibited at all times.

Contact Information

Email: Residencelife@shawu.edu

Talbot O. Shaw 1 (TOS1) Front Desk: (919)546-8515

Talbot O. Shaw 1 (TOS1) Residence Manager: (919)546-8513

Talbot O. Shaw 2 (TOS2) Front Desk: (919) 719-2280

Talbot O. Shaw 2 (TOS2) Residence Manager: (919)546-8509